Part 1: Setting up your Google Colab

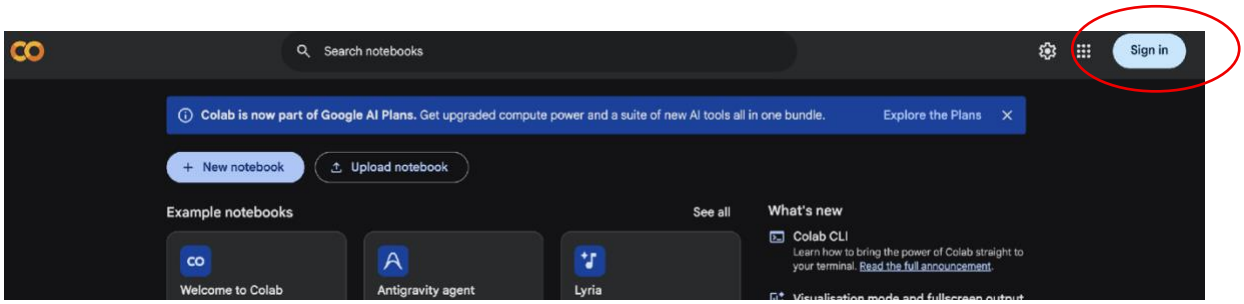
Author: Crystal Leung

Step 1: Download files

1. Download the notebook from the link (will be provided on the day of the course)
2. Save to your local computer (remember where you saved it!)
3. Keep this downloaded file as your **original copy and don't edit it.** You can refer back to it for the solutions, and if you accidentally change or delete something in Colab, you can always re-upload the original and start again.

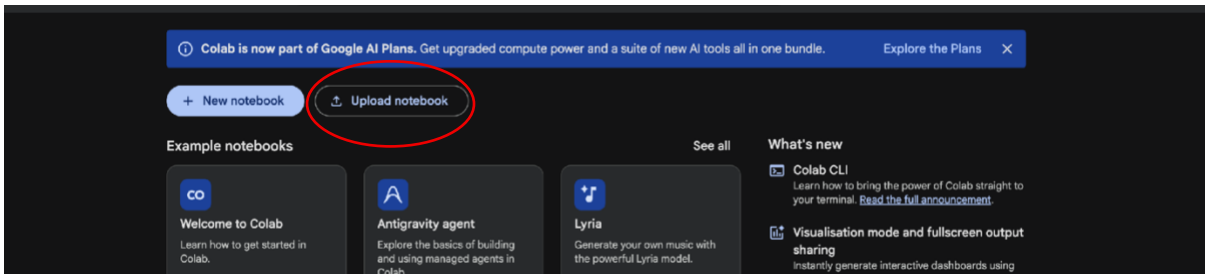
Step 2: Access Google Colab

1. Open your web browser
2. Go to colab.research.google.com
3. Sign in with your Google account using the button in the top right corner (create one if you don't have it)
4. You'll see a welcome screen — congratulations, you're in!

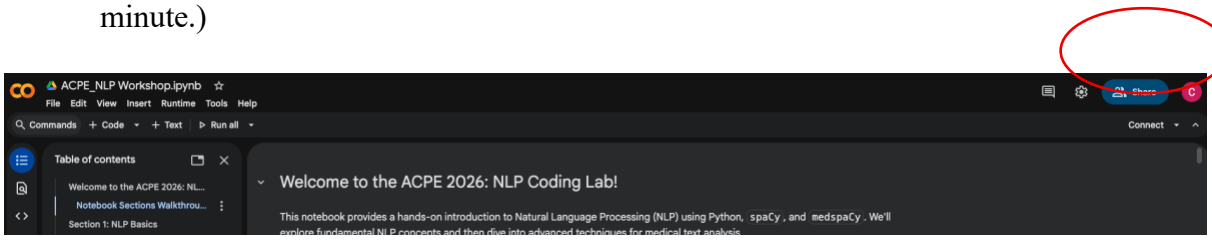


Step 3: Open the lab notebook

1. Upload the downloaded notebook.
2. **Rename your notebook.** Click the notebook name at the top left and type a new name (for example, *NLPLab_YourName.ipynb).*



3. You should see this now! Now we connect to runtime (i.e., a temporary computer environment that runs your notebook's code). (This may take up to 1 minute.)



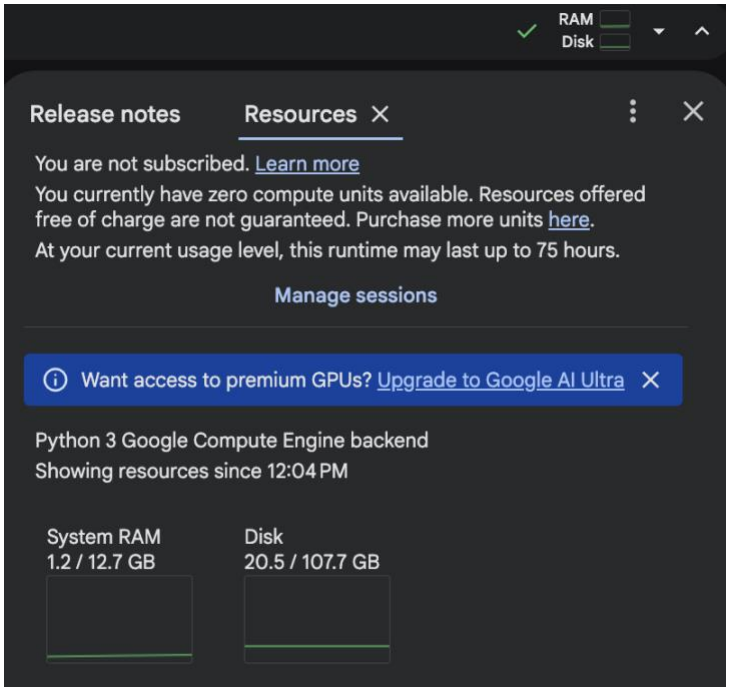
4. After being connected, you should see this.

(Note: your runtime may disconnect after a period of inactivity. If this happens, click Connect to reconnect. Reconnecting starts a fresh runtime, so installed packages and variables are lost. Re-run the notebook cells from the top (Runtime > Run all) before continuing.



You can click on it to see what resources you are connected to.

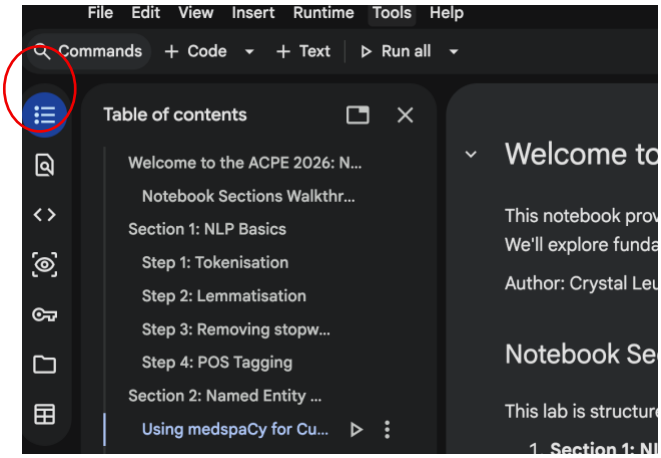
(Note: Google Colab uses dynamic resource allocation, so you may get assigned to different RAM and disk every time you try to connect)



Now you are ready for the lab!

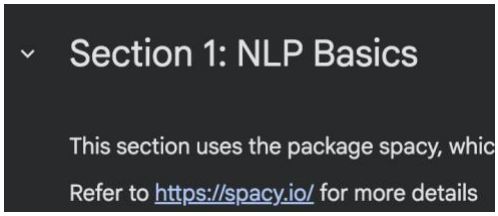
Part 2: Navigating Google Colab

The **Table of contents** is visible in the panel on the left of your page; this is useful for navigating through different sections of the lab.



There are two types of cells in Colab: a **text cell** and **code cell.**

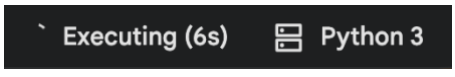
1) Text cells: simply stores text.



2) Code cells: stores executable code. Press  to run.



Code is running when you see 

You may also see how long the code has been running in the bottom-right corner. Some code may take a few minutes to run. 



This indicates the code has been successfully run. You may see the output at the bottom of the code cell

You may see this error when you try to run any code. Click Run Anyway.

